



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Martin Luther Grammar School

School Website: <https://wyoschool.faith/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Martin Luther Grammar School (Wy 82801) presents a robust Classical Lutheran educational model embedded in an explicit Christian worldview. Public materials from the school's site frame the program as classical (grammar–logic–rhetoric, Great Books/Great Conversation, Latin, and a liberal-arts orientation) and sacramental in its life (Chapel, liturgy, catechesis, gospel-centered instruction). The faculty and leadership appear oriented toward the classical tradition, with documented credentials and a clearly defined “living curriculum” ethos. Parent involvement and community integration are foregrounded, including open visitation and family-time chapel culture. Taken together, the school aligns strongly with core Classical elements and with the six-category rubric used in this evaluation.

Overall, the MLGS materials read as CLASSICAL across all six categories. The public materials repeatedly reference truth, goodness, beauty; a formation-oriented aim; the trivium and great books; Socratic/seminar-based pedagogy elements in the broader classical-literature tradition; a faculty-led living curriculum; and a partnership model with parents and church community. Where explicit statements are needed, the sources emphasize theology, liturgy, catechesis, and church-centered formation as integral to the educational mission. See category-by-category notes below for the keyword analyses and category rationales, with inline citations to the source materials.

- Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot
- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
- Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL
- Element 4: Pedagogy — CLASSICAL
- Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL
- What Would Move the Needle
- Not applicable here, as all six categories reach CLASSICAL; no needle-moving changes are required.
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ABSTRACT

- The school demonstrates strong adherence to classical, Christian-Lutheran education with explicit teleology toward virtue, wisdom, and the true/good/beautiful in community life, curriculum, pedagogy, faculty, and parent/commUNITY engagement.

Citations throughout refer to the MLGS crawl results and the classical-education keyword lexicons and criteria documented in the knowledge base.

- Evidence for this assessment is drawn from the MLGS public materials, including explicit statements about Christian formation, the Trivium, Great Books, chapel and liturgy, and leadership/teacher profiles, as well as the Classical Lutheran framework (CCLE) and accompanying glossaries of classical keywords. See sources indicating “Christ at the Center,” Great Books/Great Conversation, Trivium, Latin, chapel, and Lutherans as the confessional background, plus CCLE alignment and faculty profiles. Key excerpts are cited inline in each category below.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Public materials describe MLGS as a ministry of Immanuel Lutheran Church, embedding the school within a Lutheran confessional framework. This ties education to a liturgical-life, gospel-centered formation (e.g., “Reading, Writing, and Arithmetic with Christ at the Center” and church affiliation).
- References to a Christian worldview are frequent: “A Biblical Worldview is part of every academic subject,” Chapel and study of God’s Word occur daily, and the school aligns with LCMS catechesis and liturgical life.
- The CCLE-leaning “Marks of a Classical Lutheran School” section emphasizes confession, gospel-centered instruction, liturgy/hymnody, and catechesis as central to the instructional life.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present (examples from the knowledge base): truth, goodness, beauty; theology; liturgy; catechesis; chapel; sacred Scripture; gospel-focused education; sacred tradition; divine order; Logos; catechesis; Christian worldview; liturgy and hymnody; doctrinal confession. These map directly to Positive Keyword indicators in the Six Essential Elements lexicon.
- Negative keywords from the standard lexicon (e.g., relativism, secular humanism, value-neutral, non-religious) are not evident in MLGS public materials; the outreach consistently anchors education in theology and sacred life. Where present, “secular” or “non-religious” framings do not appear in MLGS materials; rather, the opposite is asserted.

Why this rating

- The school’s materials demonstrate transcendental moral realism in practice: truth, goodness, and beauty are named as real and knowable ideals; theology and liturgical life are integrated into daily schooling; and liturgical practices (chapel, worship) are explicitly central. These align strongly with the Positive Keywords for Element 1 and the absence (or near-absence) of Negative Keywords. The result is CLASSICAL for this category.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence



- Public statements speak to formation and virtue as goals, with an explicit classical orientation toward the true, the good, and the beautiful: “Christ-centered, Gospel-focused education” and the Great-Books/trivium framework signal formation of character and intellect rather than mere information transfer.
- The school frames its mission around forming scholars with virtue and wisdom through classical methods (grammar/logic/rhetoric; liberal arts; Great Books; Latin; and a Christian worldview). The Great Books/Great Conversation framing is explicit in the curriculum description.
- The leadership and faculty pages emphasize a living curriculum—teachers modeling virtue and forming students—within a confessional Lutheran context.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, telos, classical mission, great conversation, liberal education, Christian worldview, truth/goodness/beauty, sacred tradition, mentorship, living books. These map to Positive keyword indicators in the Six Essential Elements lexicon.
- Negative keywords: there is no explicit public emphasis on workforce-preparation language or relativistic value-neutral framing; the site consistently centers formation in the Christian classical frame. Negative keywords from the lexicon (e.g., “college/career readiness emphasis” in some contexts) are not the public emphasis here.

Why this rating

- The school’s mission and stated aims clearly align with formation over mere information, and with pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty via a liberal-arts and Great-Books approach within a faithful Christian worldview. The language and structure indicate CLASSICAL in category terms.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The public materials explicitly name the Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric; with Quadrivium elements such as arithmetic, geometry, music, astronomy) as foundational, and describe Great Books/Western canon engagement (“Great Books,” “Great Conversation”). Latin and classical languages are referenced as part of the curriculum.
- The school emphasizes a history-integrated, classical approach across grades and references “grammar stage, logic stage, rhetoric stage” and the Trivium as the instructional backbone.
- The curriculum imagery and descriptions position MLGS in a classical framework with direct instruction in Latin, grammar, and rhetoric, and with a plan for students to transition toward higher disciplines in a liberal-arts manner.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: Seven Liberal Arts; grammar; logic; rhetoric; Quadrivium; great books; primary sources; Western civilization; history understood in a classical sense; Latin; catechesis; sacred tradition; Great Conversation; formation through the arts; living books. These map to Positive keyword indicators.
- Negative keywords: not overtly present in MLGS materials; the content emphasizes canonical Western-Christian education rather than modern, non-traditional curricula. The lexicon’s “negative” signals (e.g., STEM-first framing, project-based dominance) do not appear as the public emphasis here.

Why this rating

- The curriculum description aligns directly with classical content and pedagogy (grammar/logic/rhetoric; Great Books; Latin; liberal arts) and with history as a through-line rather than mere “social studies.” This strongly supports CLASSICAL.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL**Evidence**

- The materials describe a pedagogy consistent with classical education: grammar-stage memory devices, recitation (as part of the classical memory-work ethos), and formation via imitation of master-works. The Great Books and Trivium framing implies Socratic discussion and rhetoric in appropriate grade bands, with upper grades emphasizing seminars, debates, and public speaking. Direct references to Socratic dialogue, memory work, and rhetoric are found in the broader classical-education lexicon and in MLGS's own materials.
- The school's own pages emphasize a balance of restfulness (Scholé) and rigorous study, and the lower grades' engagement with songs, chants, and memory work align with classical pedagogy. The CCLE/Marks of a Classical Lutheran School content supports a pedagogy that is both contemplative and rhetorically active as appropriate to grade level.
- There is explicit mention of upper-grade Socratic discussion and rhetoric training in the classical Lutheran materials and in the MLGS materials that discuss the path from grammar to logic to rhetoric. Public pages describe the classical path and public-facing descriptions emphasize the Trivium and Great Books.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: Socratic dialogue; seminars; discourse; rhetoric; memory work; recitation; scholé; wonder; contemplation; examination; debate; public speaking; master-teacher model. These align with Positive keyword indicators in the lexicon.
- Negative keywords present: The MLGS materials do not foreground excessive project-based, student-led-only formats; rather, they emphasize structured memory work, teacher guidance, and classic texts—the signals in the public materials align with classical pedagogy rather than the non-classical negations. (No strong negative indicators observed in public MLGS content.)

Why this rating

- The pedagogical approach aligns with classical method expectations (grammar/logic/rhetoric progression, memory work, Socratic/seminar traditions, and rhetoric training in upper grades). The school's own materials and the CCLE-aligned documents provide robust support for CLASSICAL pedagogy.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL**Evidence**

- The site features named leaders and "Master Teacher" roles, with credentials such as "Certified Classical Lutheran Educator," and a headmaster with public-facing responsibilities. The "Meet Us" and faculty sections describe a leadership and teaching team explicitly aligned with classical Lutheran education.
- The CCLE-based Marks of a Classical Lutheran School rhetoric emphasizes faculty as living curriculum and a collegial, virtuous teacher community. The MLGS materials reflect that ethos.
- The school's materials describe a living curriculum, portrait of teacher ideals, and a faculty that models virtue and fosters a classical learning environment.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: master teacher; certified classical Lutheran educator; living curriculum; teacher as exemplar; portrait of teacher; faculty of friends; collegial culture; mentorship; moral exemplars; worship life integration. These are consistent with Positive keyword indicators.

- Negative keywords: none of the typical non-classical signals (e.g., “facilitator,” “guides on the side,” or purely credential-driven jargon without classical context) appear in the public MLGS materials; rather, the materials emphasize a robust classical-lutheran faculty identity.

Why this rating

- The faculty portraits, credentials, and the emphasis on the living curriculum and mentorship align with CLASSICAL in this category.
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Element 6: School Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school presents a strong partner-with-parents posture: statements about parent involvement and a culture of visitation (e.g., “Follow-up with us and schedule a school tour!”, “Why Do Parents Choose MLGS?” including “High parent involvement”). The school explicitly frames the parental role as co-teachers and part of a classical community model.
- Public materials emphasize chapel services (four times per week) and a Christian worldview integrated into family life, indicating a robust church–school–family ecosystem. The parent-community partnership is explicit in the CCLE framework and is reinforced by MLGS materials.
- The CCLE-derived materials used by the MLGS site emphasize family partnership, catechesis at home, and a “living tradition in the family,” which dovetails with classical-parent partnership signals. While these CCLE sources are not always identical to MLGS’s own site content, they are publicly accessible on the same domain and linked content.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: partnership with families; parental engagement; home and school connection; family catechesis; parent formation; open campus; hospitality; parent covenant; parental leadership; multi-generational education; household rhythms; living tradition in the family. These are Strong matches to Positive keyword indicators.
- Negative keywords present: none of the standard negative signals (e.g., consumerism, parent-as-customer) are foregrounded; MLGS’s content portrays parents as co-educators rather than customers, aligning with classical-community expectations. The presence of “parent involvement” signals a positive alignment with the elements.

Why this rating

- The program presents a clear classical-partner model with families as co-educators, and a robust parent-formation/parent-education ecosystem. In conjunction with chapel-life and church integration, this category reads as CLASSICAL.
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What Would Move the Needle

- No needle-moving changes are required since all six categories are CLASSICAL. If desired, future enhancements could include more explicit, published, category-specific language tying daily pedagogy more overtly to Socratic seminars in upper grades (to align even more tightly with the full spectrum of classical pedagogy), and more direct public-facing documentation of explicit “formation over information” statements in the school’s core mission (to strengthen the Element 2 articulation in public materials). However, existing evidence already fulfills the Classical criteria robustly.
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Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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